



September 20, 2026

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Presidential Postdoctoral Fellowship in the School of Information at the University of Michigan. I am a PhD Candidate in Computer Science, School of Computing and Artificial Intelligence at the University of Wisconsin–Madison. I am advised by Dr. Rahul Chatterjee and expect to graduate by Summer 2027.

My research examines how technology enables gender-based interpersonal and structural violence (GBV), and yet, provide spaces of reclamation and radical possibility that fosters collective safety, resistance, and liberation among impacted communities. My research engages with many disciplines: Human-Computer Interaction (HCI), Security & Privacy (S&P), and Social/Critical Computing. I have made contributions across two interwoven threads: (1) designing interventions to support interpersonal violence survivors, and (2) research and design framework to help communities liberate from structural violence. I have published 9 peer-reviewed papers (including 4 under review) in top-tier HCI and S&P research venues, such as CHI (best paper top 1%), CSCW (honorable mention top 5%), DIS, USENIX Security, CCS, and, NDSS. I have also presented papers, panels, and, workshops at interdisciplinary venues like [Heidelberg Laureate Forum](#), [Wisconsin State Capitol](#), [Cook County Human Trafficking Task Force Conference](#), [Socialism Conference](#), [Gayabii Gawiin](#), [Women Are Sacred Conference](#), [Reclaiming Our Love Conference](#), and, [Native Nations Nursing, Helpers, and Healers Summit](#). To support my work, I co-authored five grant proposals, one of which was awarded funding from US Department of Justice, Office for Victims of Crime (OVC) to expand [Madison Tech Clinic \(MTC\)](#) to rural and Indigenous communities. My papers have been assigned readings for two iterations of UW-Madison Prof. LB Klein's social work course on Interpersonal Violence.

Embracing an *advocacy-researcher* practice, I direct the operations and outreach at MTC, a trauma-informed intervention that has supported 180+ survivors with their digital safety needs. I have personally supported 40+ survivors and lead the outreach efforts to spread MTCs' services across 24 organizations in 32 counties in Wisconsin, US. I have formally trained over 200 health practitioners, lawyers, judges, and policymakers through nation-level ([National Indigenous Women's Resource Center](#), [National Network of Ending Domestic Violence](#), [Lac Courte Oreilles Tribal Nation](#)) and state-level coalitions ([EndAbuse](#), [The Network](#), and [Mending the Sacred Hoop](#)). Recognizing my practice, I have been awarded the [Morgridge Fellowship for Community-Engaged Scholarship](#). Going forward, I will setup a community-engaged research program by establishing a Tech Clinic in Ann Arbor.

I will collaborate with faculty mentors: **Nazanin Andalibi**, **Sarita Schoenebeck**, **Patricia Garcia**, **Justine Zhang** to bootstrap my research. I am currently working with Prof. Nazanin Andalibi on a project that situates AI data centers' role in settler-colonial violence and Indigenous resistance movements to fight back. I have previously co-authored a workshop proposal on extending violence as an epistemic object to cross disciplinary borders with Prof. Justine Zhang. I will collaborate extensively across University of Michigan's centers, such as [Center for Ethics, Society, and Computing \(ESC\)](#), [Digital Studies Institute](#), [Digital Inequality Lab](#), [Institute for Healthcare Policy and Innovation \(IHPI\)](#), [Center for Social Media Responsibility \(CSMR\)](#), [Initiative to End Sexual and Gender Harassment, Harm, and Violence](#) in [Institute for Research on Women & Gender \(IRWG\)](#). To secure funding, I plan to write grants with national agencies: NSF, DOJ, NIH; and seed grant and fellowships from private foundations and the university. As a teacher, I strive to cultivate intellectual rigor and compassionate care among students. I will incorporate an interdisciplinary perspective while teaching courses on ethics, social justice, S&P, HCI, and research methods.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Naman Gupta, PhD Candidate